IN THE PRODUCER'S SEAT

Actor **Richa Chadha** on being a first-time producer with *Girls Will Be Girls*, which released recently on Prime Video, and being a new mother

Q. What made you greenlight *Girls Will Be Girls* as your first production?
Shuchi Talati, the director, is a long-time friend of mine; we went to college together. I knew that whatever she would write would be very fresh and would be a new take on how things are generally looked at. In her personal life too, she is curious, intelligent and non-judgemental. I was one of the first people to read her script. We took it to a film bazaar and from there, it took on a journey of its own.

Q. How has Shuchi brought a unique perspective to female sexuality and the mother-daughter relationship?
The script is very special. There is a lot of finesse and refinement in the writing. Shuchi's grasp over her craft is incredible and once you see the script and the compassion with which the characters come through, it is a testament to that.

Q. Along with this new baby, you and Ali also had your first child. How has it been managing the roles of mother, actor, producer?
It is not possible to do this without the right support, whether it is your spouse or the nanny. In both cases, I have been lucky. I make sure I am around every time my baby needs to be fed. I position my work around my house, whether it's the launch of the trailer or the interviews.

Q. What's next for you as an actor and as a producer?
As a producer, there are multiple things in different spaces. As an actor, I think I will be able to return to work sometime around February. I wanted to take a little break after the release of *Girls Will Be Girls*. ■

–with Deepali Dhingra

